

Parham Mohammad Panahi

Curriculum Vitae

Department of Computing Science
University of Alberta
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RESEARCH INTERESTS **Machine Learning.** Specifically, model-based reinforcement learning, representation learning, and continual learning.

I want to create simple and performant RL algorithms that learn by interacting with a big world; effectively use past experience; and scale with more compute.

EDUCATION Doctor of Philosophy in Computing Science Jan 2026 – Present
[University of Alberta](#)
Advisors: [Professor Adam White](#) and [Professor Michael Bowling](#)

Master of Science in Computing Science Sep 2022 – Aug 2024
University of Alberta
Advisor: Professor Adam White
GPA: 4.00/4.00

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science Sep 2016 – Jul 2021
Azad University of Iran
GPA: 3.93/4.00

PUBLICATIONS A star(*) beside an author name indicates equal contribution.

Journal and Conference Articles

[RLJ] **Panahi, P. M.**, Ashrafi, A., Du, H., Patterson, A., White, M., White, A.. [Endpoint Replay: Compressing the Recency Buffer in Deep Reinforcement Learning](#). *The Reinforcement Learning Journal*, 2026. (33.9% acceptance rate)

[RLJ] Tang, S., Xiong X., Hakhverdyan, A., Patterson, A., Adkins, J., He, J., Elelimy, E., **Panahi, P. M.**, White, M., White, A.. [Forager: a lightweight testbed for continual learning with partial observability in RL](#). *The Reinforcement Learning Journal*, 2026. (33.9% acceptance rate)

[ICML] Mesbahi, G., **Panahi, P. M.**, Mastikhina, O., Tang, S., White, M., White, A.. [Position: Lifetime tuning is incompatible with continual reinforcement learning](#). *Forty-second International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2025. (19.7% acceptance rate)

[RLJ] **Panahi, P. M.**, Patterson, A., White, M., White, A.. [Investigating the Interplay of Prioritized Replay and Generalization](#). *The Reinforcement Learning Journal*, 2024. (39% acceptance rate)

[JMLR] *Lo, C., *Roice, K., ***Panahi, P. M.**, Jordan, S., White, A., Mihucz, G., Aminmansour, F., White, M.. [Goal-Space Planning with Subgoal Models](#). *Journal of Machine Learning Research*, 2024. (~17% acceptance rate)

Workshop Articles and Theses

[PRL] *Roice, K., ***Panahi, P. M.**, Jordan, S. M., White, A., White, M.. [A New View on Planning in Online Reinforcement Learning](#). *Planning and Reinforcement Learning Workshop at ICAPS*, 2024.

[UofA] **Panahi, P. M.**. [Investigating the Interplay of Prioritized Replay and Generalization](#). Master of Science Thesis. *University of Alberta*, 2024.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student (Ph.D.), University of Alberta Jan 2026 – Present

Research Assistant, University of Alberta Sep 2024 – Dec 2025

- Created a compressed replay buffer algorithm for deep RL.
- Studied the role of hyperparameter selection in continual RL.

Graduate Student (M.Sc.), University of Alberta Sep 2022 – Aug 2024

- Investigated prioritized search control in experience replay buffers.
- Developed algorithms for model-based RL with temporal abstraction.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Alberta

- CMPUT 175 – *Introduction to Computing 2* Fall 2022, Winter 2023
- CMPUT 655 – *Reinforcement Learning 1 (Graduate Level)* Fall 2025
- CMPUT 365 – *Reinforcement Learning 1* Winter 2026

Content Development, Alberta Machine Intelligence Institute 2023–2024

- Helped Develop INT D 161 – *Artificial Intelligence Everywhere*

AWARDS

- *Graduate Recruitment Scholarship*, University of Alberta, 2026
- *Graduate Travel Awards*, University of Alberta, 2023
- *Accepted to DLRL Summer School*, Canada CIFAR, 2023
- *Graduate Recruitment Scholarship*, University of Alberta, 2022
- *Rank 25 at the Mathematics Olympiad*, National Universities of Iran, 2021

SERVICE AND
OUTREACH

- Reviewer for RLC 2024, 2025, 2026, ICLR 2026, NeurIPS 2026.
- Co-organizer, the RLAI Summit Workshop, 2024

SKILLS

- *Programming:* Python, Rust, Julia, C++, Numpy, Jax, PyTorch
- *Tools:* Linux, HPC, Git, Latex, LLM Agents